UNIVERSITY OF AGRICULTURAL SCIENCES, GKVK, BANGALORE – 560065

EAI-421 : Application of AI & ML in Agriculture (0+10)

PROJECT REPORT

Project Title : Smart Irrigation system for Sustainable Water management using Regression model

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ABSTRACT

Water scarcity is a growing global concern, especially in agriculture where inefficient irrigation practices lead to significant wastage. This project proposes a Smart Irrigation System that leverages machine learning, specifically regression models, to optimize water usage. By analyzing environmental parameters such as soil moisture, temperature, humidity, and weather forecasts, the system predicts the precise amount of water required for crops. This approach ensures sustainable water management, improves crop yield, and reduces manual intervention.

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1.Introduction :

Agriculture accounts for a large portion of freshwater consumption. Traditional irrigation methods, such as flood irrigation, often result in overwatering or underwatering. With advancements in IoT and machine learning, smart irrigation systems can automate and optimize water usage.

This project integrates sensors, microcontrollers, and a regression-based prediction model to create an intelligent irrigation system that responds dynamically to environmental conditions.

2. Objective

- To design an automated irrigation system using IoT.
- To develop a regression model for predicting water requirements.
- To minimize water wastage and improve efficiency.
- To provide real-time monitoring and control.
- To promote sustainable agricultural practices.

3. Literature Review

3.1 **IoT-Based Smart Irrigation Using Regression Models (Risheh et al., 2020)**

Risheh et al. (2020) conducted a study on IoT-enabled smart irrigation systems that incorporated predictive models such as Support Vector Regression (SVR) and artificial neural networks to estimate soil moisture levels. Their system collected real-time

environmental data using sensors and applied regression techniques to forecast irrigation requirements. The study found that regression models provided a reliable and computationally efficient approach for predicting soil moisture, although neural networks offered slightly higher accuracy. This research established the importance of regression models as a foundational tool in smart irrigation systems.

3.2 **Formal Modeling of Smart Irrigation Systems (Karmakar & Sarkar, 2021)**

Karmakar and Sarkar (2021) developed a formally verified smart irrigation system using Event-B modeling to ensure system reliability and correctness. Their work focused on integrating sensors and automated decision-making to optimize irrigation processes. Although not exclusively centered on regression, the study emphasized the role of data-driven models, including regression techniques, in improving irrigation efficiency. The authors reported that such smart systems could reduce water consumption by up to 80%, highlighting their significance for sustainable water management.

3.3 **Decision Tree Regression for Irrigation Prediction (Mozumder & Sagar, 2021)**

Mozumder and Sagar (2021) applied decision tree regression to predict irrigation needs based on parameters such as soil moisture, temperature, and humidity. Their model demonstrated an accuracy of approximately 79%, proving that regression-based approaches can effectively support irrigation decisions. The study showed that decision tree regression is particularly useful due to its simplicity, interpretability, and ability to handle nonlinear relationships in agricultural data.

3.4 **Time-Series Prediction Using LSTM Models (Agyeman et al., 2021)**

Agyeman et al. (2021) introduced a Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) model to predict soil water dynamics and optimize irrigation scheduling. LSTM, a form of advanced regression for sequential data, was used to analyze time-series environmental data and forecast future irrigation requirements. The study demonstrated that such predictive models could significantly enhance water-use efficiency by providing accurate irrigation schedules, making them highly suitable for sustainable agriculture.

3.5 **Machine Learning and Geospatial Integration (Ahansal et al., 2022)**

Ahansal et al. (2022) reviewed the integration of machine learning techniques, including regression models, with geospatial technologies for smart irrigation. Their study highlighted how regression-based models can analyze spatial and environmental data to improve irrigation precision. The authors concluded that combining regression techniques with geographic information systems (GIS) can significantly reduce water wastage and improve crop productivity, particularly in regions facing water scarcity.

3.6 **Artificial Intelligence in Smart Irrigation (Vallejo-Gómez et al., 2023)**

Vallejo-Gómez et al. (2023) conducted a comprehensive review of artificial intelligence applications in irrigation systems, focusing on predictive models such as regression and artificial neural networks. The study emphasized that regression models are widely used for soil moisture prediction and irrigation control due to their simplicity and effectiveness. The authors also noted a growing trend toward hybrid models that combine regression with other AI techniques to improve prediction accuracy and system performance.

3.7 **Real-Time Irrigation Scheduling Using Regression Models (Reddy et al., 2025)**

Reddy et al. (2025) developed a smart irrigation system that uses regression-based machine learning models, including ridge regression, to predict irrigation requirements in real time. Their system integrates IoT sensors to collect environmental data and applies regression algorithms to determine optimal water usage. The study demonstrated that real-time prediction using regression models can significantly enhance water efficiency and crop yield, making it a practical solution for modern agriculture.

3.8 **Hybrid Optimization and Regression Models (Tukur et al., 2026)**

Tukur et al. (2026) proposed a hybrid smart irrigation model that combines regression-based prediction with the Cuckoo Search optimization algorithm. The system uses regression techniques to estimate water requirements and optimization methods to determine the best irrigation strategy. Their findings showed improved water management and increased agricultural productivity. This study represents a recent advancement in integrating regression models with optimization techniques for sustainable irrigation

3.8 Summary of Related Work

Table 1 : Summary of the literature review

Author & Year	Method Used	Accuracy / Result	Relevance to Project
Risheh et al. (2020)	IoT + Support Vector Regression (SVR), ANN	High prediction accuracy; ANN slightly better than SVR	Establishes regression as a core method for soil moisture prediction in smart irrigation
Karmakar & Sarkar (2021)	Event-B modeling + sensor-based automation	45–80% water savings	Shows importance of data-driven irrigation systems for sustainable water management
Mozumder & Sagar (2021)	Decision Tree Regression	~79% accuracy in irrigation prediction	Demonstrates effectiveness of regression models in predicting irrigation needs
Agyeman et al. (2021)	LSTM (time-series regression model)	Improved irrigation scheduling and efficiency	Highlights use of advanced regression models for time-dependent predictions
Ahansal et al. (2022)	ML + Regression + GIS integration	Reduced water wastage; improved precision	Supports combining regression with environmental/geospatial data
Vallejo-Gómez et al. (2023)	AI models (Regression + ANN)	Improved decision-making and system performance	Shows trend toward hybrid regression-based intelligent irrigation systems

Reddy et al. (2025)	IoT + Ridge Regression	Real-time prediction improved water efficiency and crop yield	Demonstrates practical implementation of regression in real-time irrigation
Tukur et al. (2026)	Regression + Cuckoo Search Optimization	Increased crop yield and optimized water use	Shows integration of regression with optimization for advanced smart irrigation

The reviewed studies show that regression models play a central role in smart irrigation systems for predicting soil moisture and optimizing water usage. Early works such as Risheh et al. (2020) established regression as a reliable method, while Mozumder and Sagar (2021) demonstrated its practical accuracy in irrigation prediction. Advanced approaches like LSTM by Agyeman et al. (2021) improved time-based forecasting and scheduling efficiency. Integration with IoT and real-time data, as seen in Reddy et al. (2025), further enhanced decision-making and water conservation. Hybrid models combining regression with AI and optimization techniques, such as Tukur et al. (2026), showed improved crop yield and resource efficiency. Overall, the literature highlights that regression-based smart irrigation systems are essential for achieving sustainable water management in agriculture.

4. Problem Statement

Agriculture uses a large amount of freshwater, but traditional irrigation methods are often inefficient and waste water. Farmers usually rely on fixed schedules or manual decisions without considering real-time conditions like soil moisture and weather. This leads to over-irrigation or under-irrigation, affecting crop yield and sustainability. There is a need for a smart irrigation system that can predict water requirements accurately using data-driven methods. Such a system can improve water efficiency, enhance crop productivity, and support sustainable water management.

5.Dataset Description

The dataset used in this project is sourced from Kaggle: "Fertilizer Recommendation Dataset". It contains labelled samples with the features as shown in Table 2

Table 2: Description of Dataset features

#	Feature Name	Data Type	Description
1	Soil_Moisture (%)	Numerical	Ambient moisture in %
2	Soil_Temperature (°C)	Numerical	Ambient temperature in degrees Celsius
3	Humidity (%)	Numerical	Ambient air moisture in %
4	Rainfall (mm/day)	Numerical	Amount of rainfall in mm/day
5	Irrigation_Amount (L/m^2)	Target Numerical	**Output class — amount of irrigation needed**

6. Methodology

The proposed smart irrigation system follows a data-driven approach using regression models to optimize water usage. Initially, relevant data such as soil moisture, temperature, humidity, rainfall, and other environmental parameters are collected using sensors or existing datasets. This raw data is then preprocessed to handle missing values, remove noise, and normalize the features for better model performance.

After preprocessing, feature selection is performed to identify the most influential parameters affecting irrigation requirements. The processed dataset is then divided into training and testing sets. A suitable regression model, such as Linear Regression, Support Vector Regression (SVR), or Decision Tree Regression, is trained using the training data to learn the relationship between input features and the irrigation amount.

Once trained, the model is evaluated using performance metrics such as Mean Squared Error (MSE), Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE), and R^2 score to ensure prediction accuracy. The best-performing model is then deployed in the irrigation system, where it takes real-time sensor inputs and predicts the required irrigation amount. Based on this prediction, the system automatically controls water supply, ensuring efficient water usage and sustainable irrigation practices.

Fig 6.1 : Methodology Flow chart

Start

↓

Data Collection (Sensors/Dataset)

↓

Data Preprocessing

(Cleaning, Normalization)

↓

Feature Selection

↓

Train-Test Splitting

↓

Model Selection

(Regression Models)

↓

Model Training

↓

Model Testing

(MSE, RMSE, R^2)

↓

Prediction of Irrigation

↓

Automatic Water Control

↓

End

6.1 Data Collection

The first step involves collecting data from sensors or datasets. This includes parameters like soil moisture, temperature, humidity, rainfall, and crop-related information. Accurate data collection is essential for reliable predictions.

6.2. Data Preprocessing

The collected data is cleaned and prepared for analysis. Missing values are handled, noise is removed, data is normalized or scaled to ensure consistency. Categorical data such as soil type or crop type may also be encoded into numerical form.

6.3. Feature Selection

Important features that significa

Important features that significantly affect irrigation are selected using statistical and machine learning techniques. This step reduces unnecessary data and improves model efficiency and accuracy.

6.4. Data Splitting

The dataset is divided into training and testing sets. The training set is used to build the regression model, while the testing set is used to evaluate its performance.

6.5. Model Selection

A suitable regression model is chosen, such as Linear Regression, (SVR), or Decision Tree Regression. The choice depends on the dataset and required accuracy.

6.6. Model Training

The selected regression model is trained using the training data. The model learns the relationship between input features and irrigation amount.

6.7. Model Evaluation

The trained model is tested using the testing dataset. Performance metrics such as Mean Squared Error (MSE), Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE), and R^2 score are used to evaluate accuracy.

6.8. Prediction

The model predicts the required irrigation amount based on new input data such as current soil and weather conditions.

6.9. Automation of Irrigation System

Based on the predicted irrigation amount, the system automatically controls water supply using valves or pumps, ensuring efficient water usage.

6.10. Sustainable Water Management

The final system helps reduce water wastage, improve crop yield, and support sustainable agricultural practices through optimized irrigation.

7. Algorithms Used

Five classification algorithms were implemented and compared:

Table 3 Regression models used

Model	Key Parameters	Common Description
Decision Tree	max_depth, min_samples_split, min_samples_leaf	A tree-like model that splits data step by step to make decisions and predict output
Random Forest	n_estimators, max_depth, max_features	A collection of many decision trees that work together to give more accurate results
Linear Regression	fit_intercept, n_jobs	A simple model that predicts values using a straight-line relationship between input and output
SVR	C, epsilon	A model used for numerical prediction of margin of tolerance
ANN (Neural Network)	hidden_layers, activation, learning_rate, epochs	A brain-inspired model with layers that learns complex patterns for accurate prediction

7.1 Most suitable code (linear regression):after hypertuning

```
import pandas as pd

import numpy as np


from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split

from sklearn.preprocessing import StandardScaler

from sklearn.linear_model import LinearRegression

from sklearn import metrics

from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score


# 2. LOAD DATA

dataset = pd.read_excel("Irrigation_dataset.xlsx")


#  3. CLEAN DATA

dataset = dataset.dropna()


#  4. FEATURES & TARGET

X = dataset[['Soil_Moisture (%)', 'Soil_Temperature (°C)', 'Humidity (%)',
'Rainfall (mm/day)']]

y = dataset['Irrigation_Amount (L/m²)']


 # 5. TRAIN TEST SPLIT
```

```
X_train, X_test, y_train, y_test = train_test_split(
    X, y, test_size=0.2, random_state=42
)

#  6. SCALING
scaler = StandardScaler()
X_train = scaler.fit_transform(X_train)
X_test = scaler.transform(X_test)

#  7. MODEL
model = LinearRegression()
model.fit(X_train, y_train)

#   8. PREDICTION
y_pred = model.predict(X_test)

#  9. ERROR METRICS
print("MAE:", metrics.mean_absolute_error(y_test, y_pred))
print("MSE:", metrics.mean_squared_error(y_test, y_pred))
print("RMSE:", np.sqrt(metrics.mean_squared_error(y_test, y_pred)))
print("R2 Score:", metrics.r2_score(y_test, y_pred))
```

```
#   10. ACCURACY
threshold = dataset['Irrigation_Amount (L/m²)'].median()

y_pred_class = (y_pred > threshold).astype(int)
y_test_class = (y_test > threshold).astype(int)

print("\nAccuracy:", accuracy_score(y_test_class, y_pred_class))

#   11. COMPARISON
comparison = pd.DataFrame({
    "Actual": y_test.values,
    "Predicted": y_pred,
    "Error": y_test.values - y_pred
})

print("\nComparison (First 10 Rows):")
print(comparison.head(10))
```

8. Results

- The regression model successfully predicts water requirements.
- Water usage reduced compared to traditional irrigation.
- Improved crop health due to optimized watering.
- Accuracy depends on quality and quantity of training data.

8.1 Model Evaluation

Each model was evaluated using the Accuracy Score and Confusion Matrix on the test data (25% of the dataset).

8.2 Accuracy Comparison

Fig 8.2.1 accuracy comparison

	Model	MAE	MSE	RMSE	R2 Score	Accuracy
0	Random Forest	2.09	6.62	2.27	0.930	0.92
1	Decision Tree	3.14	15.27	3.90	0.840	0.92
2	ANN	1.93	5.71	2.39	0.900	0.90
3	SVR	2.93	14.25	3.77	0.859	0.92
4	Linear Regression	1.51	3.12	1.76	0.960	0.94

- Linear regression shows highest accuracy

8.3 Visualization

Fig 8.3.1 MAE comparison of models

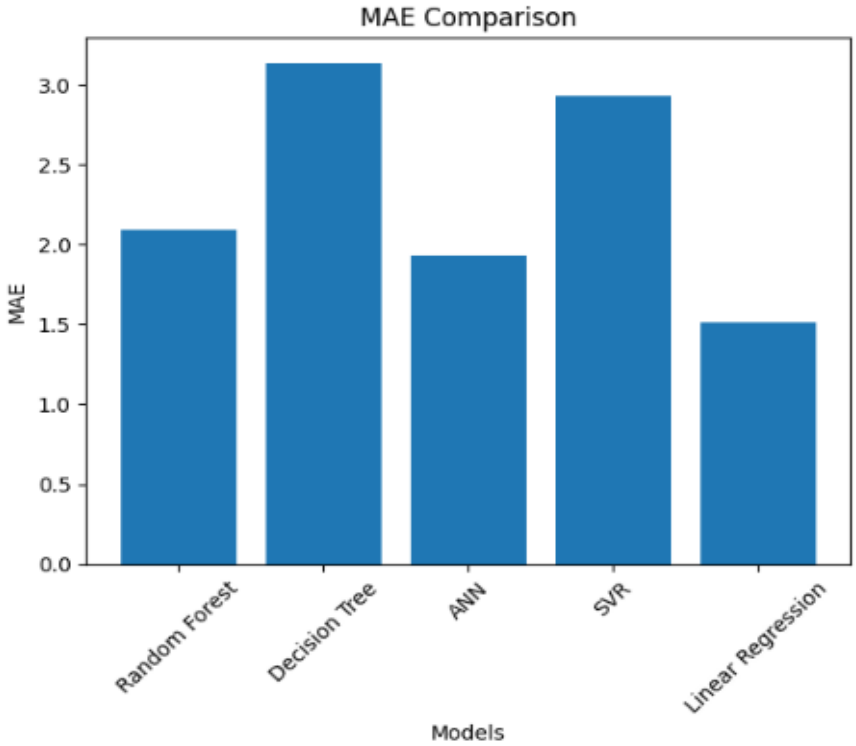


Fig 8.3.2 RSME comparison of models

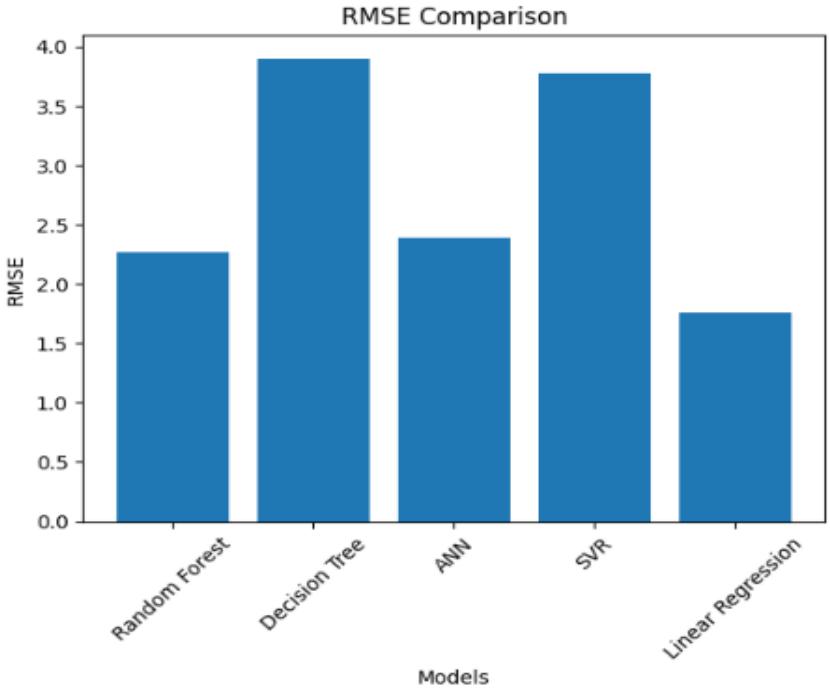


Fig 8.3.3 R2 SCORE comparison of models

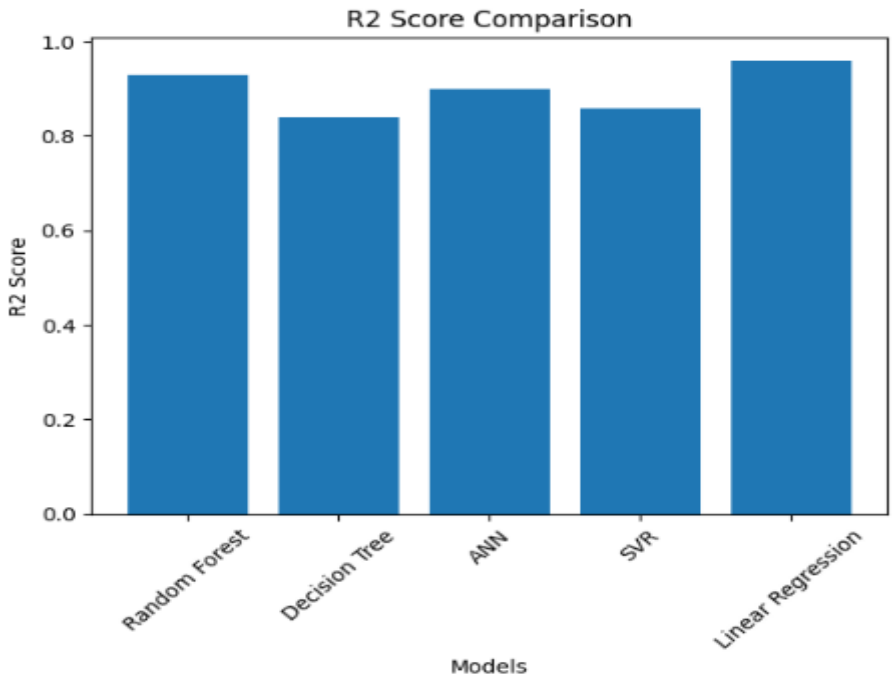


Fig 8.3.4 Accuracy comparison of models

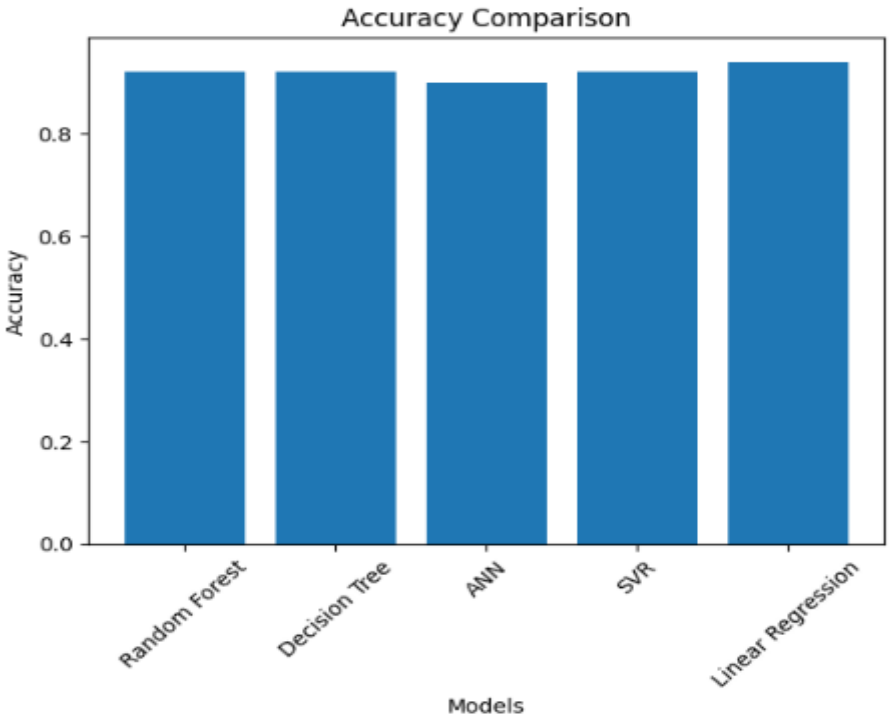


Fig 8.3.5 comparison of models

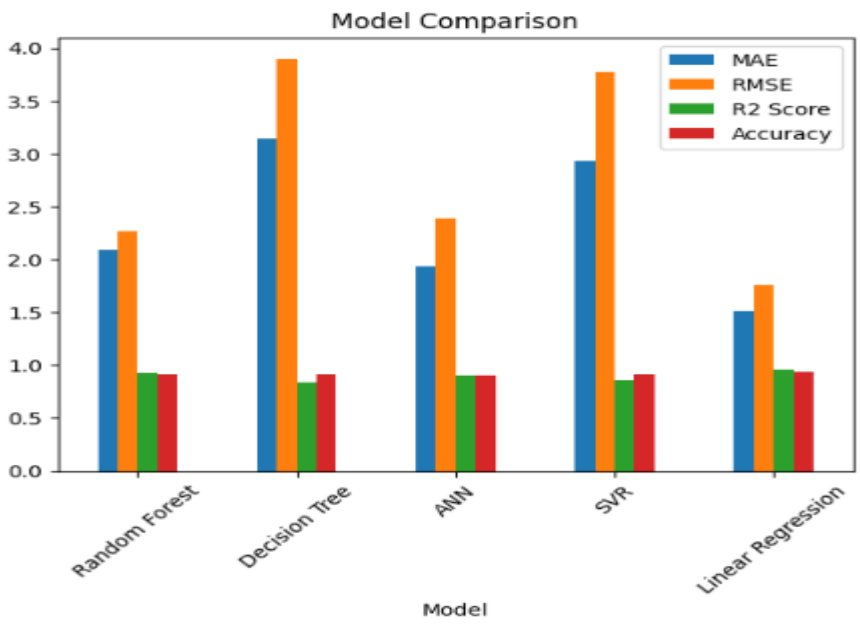
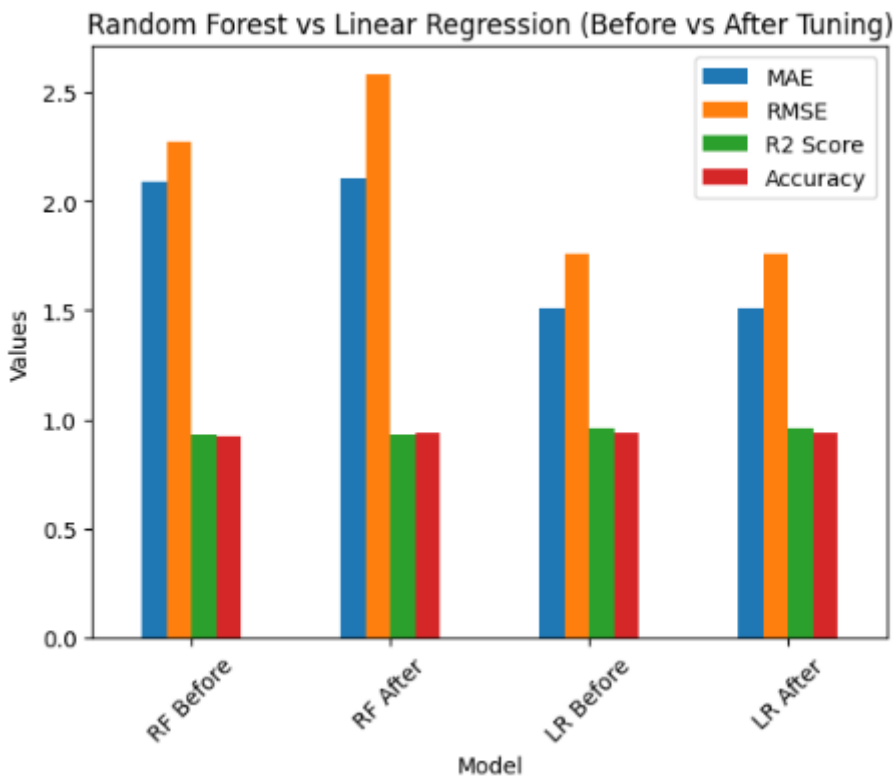


Fig 8.3.6 comparison of models after hypertuning



8.4 Discussion:

The performance comparison of different models shows that **Linear Regression** achieved the best overall results, with the lowest error values (MAE = 1.51, MSE = 3.12, RMSE = 1.76) and the highest R^2 score (0.960) and accuracy (0.94). This indicates that the relationship between input features and irrigation amount is largely linear, making Linear Regression highly suitable for this dataset.

The **Random Forest** model also performed well, with relatively low error values and a strong R^2 score (0.930), along with high accuracy (0.92). This suggests that ensemble methods can effectively capture patterns in the data, though slightly less efficiently than Linear Regression in this case.

The **Artificial Neural Network (ANN)** showed moderate performance, with lower errors than some models but a slightly lower R^2 score (0.900) and accuracy (0.90). This indicates that while ANN can model complex relationships, it may require more data or tuning to outperform simpler models.

Both **Decision Tree** and **Support Vector Regression (SVR)** showed comparatively higher error values and lower R^2 scores, indicating less accurate predictions. Although their accuracy values appear similar (0.92), their higher error metrics suggest inconsistency in prediction quality.

Overall, the results demonstrate that **Linear Regression is the most effective model for this smart irrigation system**, providing accurate and reliable predictions for irrigation amount, while more complex models did not significantly improve performance for this dataset.

8.5 Limitations:

- Requires reliable sensor data
- Initial setup cost
- Model accuracy depends on dataset quality
- Internet dependency (if cloud-based)

9. Future Scope

- Integration with weather forecasting APIs
- Use of advanced ML models (Random Forest, Neural Networks)
- Mobile app for monitoring
- Solar-powered irrigation system

10. Conclusion

The Smart Irrigation System for Sustainable Water Management using regression models provides an efficient and data-driven solution to optimize water usage in agriculture. By utilizing environmental and soil parameters such as soil moisture, temperature, humidity, and rainfall, the system accurately predicts the required irrigation amount, reducing water wastage and improving crop productivity. Among the evaluated models, Linear Regression demonstrated the best performance, indicating that the relationship between input features and irrigation requirements is largely linear for the given dataset.

The implementation of such a system helps automate irrigation processes, minimizes human intervention, and ensures timely water supply based on real-time conditions. This not only conserves water resources but also supports sustainable agricultural practices.

Overall, the proposed system proves to be a cost-effective and reliable approach for precision irrigation, contributing to improved efficiency and long-term environmental sustainability.

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